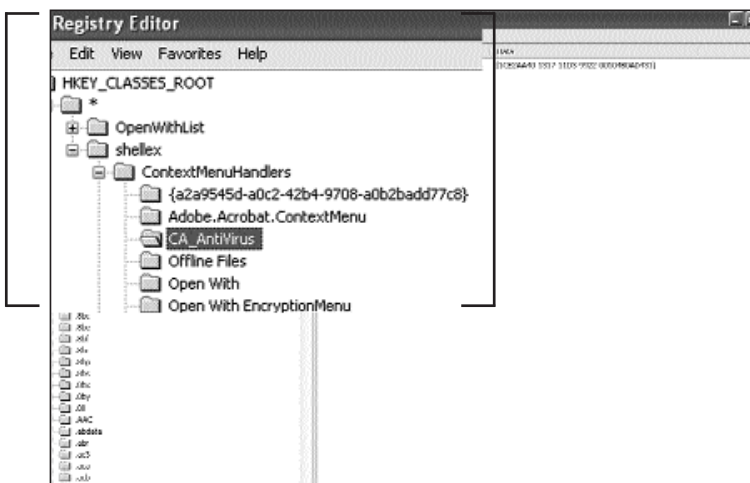


1.2 The Structure And Working Of The Registry

Registry editors visually depict the logical hierarchy into which the entire Registry is organised. Similar to the folder and sub-folder structure in Explorer, the Registry is divided into six main branches called hives.

Each of these hives contain keys, sub-keys and perhaps sub-sub-keys. Visualise this as sub-folders under a main folder. Each key or sub-key can also contain values. These values are where the information regarding software, hardware, and users is stored. The values are categorised into three primary types: **DWORD**, **String**, and **Binary**. These and some expansions based on them are used depending on the context of the key. “String” is used for human-readable text entries, “binary” for most hardware and device settings data in raw binary entered in hexadecimal format, and **DWORD** is allowed for Boolean entries where the option is a list of choices, each of which could invoke a different behaviour by the relevant section of the operating system, hardware, or the application.



Much of the Registry looks like this—keys, sub-keys, and sub-sub-keys